

-- quick guide · 10 commands

SQL

SQL explained for beginners

Ten keywords that handle **90% of your day** with databases.

SELECT

Pick which columns you want

Ask a table for the columns you need.

* means **all of them**.

```
select.sql

-- all columns
SELECT * FROM users;

-- only the ones you need
SELECT name, email FROM users;
```

```
-- all columns
```

```
SELECT * FROM users;
```

```
-- only the ones you need
```

```
SELECT name, email FROM users;
```



-- 02 · filter rows

WHERE

Keep only the rows that **match**

Like a search box inside the table: **filter** and keep just what you care about.

● ● ● where.sql

```
SELECT * FROM users
WHERE age ≥ 18
      AND country = 'MX';
```



ORDER BY

Sort the result **your way**

Ascending by default; add `DESC` for **highest first**.

●●● order.sql

```
SELECT name, age FROM users
ORDER BY age DESC;
```



-- 04 · cap rows

LIMIT

Ask for just a few rows

Perfect for **top-N** lists and fast table previews.

● ● ● limit.sql

```
SELECT * FROM users
ORDER BY created_at DESC
LIMIT 10;
```



JOIN

Data lives split (users, orders). JOIN connects them by a key, like `user_id`.

```
join.sql
```

```
SELECT u.name, o.total
FROM users u
JOIN orders o
      ON o.user_id = u.id;
```

-- 06 • aggregate

GROUP BY

Collapse rows into one per group

Pair it with `COUNT`, `SUM` or `AVG` to **summarize** your data.

● ● ● group.sql

```
SELECT country, COUNT(*)  
FROM users  
GROUP BY country;
```



-- 07 · search text

LIKE

Match text by a pattern

`%` is a wildcard: `'A%'` means **starts with A**.

like.sql

```
SELECT * FROM users
WHERE name LIKE 'A%';
```


INSERT

Add a new row to a table

List the columns, then the **values** that fill them.

●●● insert.sql

```
INSERT INTO users (name, age)
VALUES ('Ada', 36);
```



UPDATE

Edit rows that already exist

No **WHERE** means you change **every row**. Never forget it.

```
update.sql
```

```
UPDATE users  
SET age = 37  
WHERE id = 1;
```

```
UPDATE users
SET age = 37
WHERE id = 1;
```



-- 10 • remove data

DELETE

Remove rows you no longer need

Same rule: no **WHERE**, and the **whole table** is gone.

delete.sql

```
DELETE FROM users
WHERE id = 1;
```

-- that's the 90%

You just learned the core of SQL

Master these ten and you can query almost any database. Which one do you reach for most?



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study with me

the full source on GitHub

